

CAT Exam Overview

CAT

Introduction to CAT Exam

The Common Admission Test (CAT) is a national-level management entrance examination conducted by the Indian Institute of Management (IIM) for admission to various management programs. It is a prerequisite for admission to the IIMs and several other top business schools in India. The exam is designed to test a candidate's quantitative ability, logical reasoning, and language skills.

Exam Sections

The CAT exam consists of three main sections - Verbal Ability and Reading Comprehension (VARC), Data Interpretation and Logical Reasoning (DILR), and Quantitative Ability (QA). Each section is designed to test a specific set of skills and knowledge. The VARC section tests a candidate's language skills, including reading comprehension and verbal ability. The DILR section tests a candidate's ability to interpret data and solve logical reasoning problems. The QA section tests a candidate's quantitative skills, including mathematics and numerical ability.

- VARC: Verbal Ability and Reading Comprehension (54-60 questions, 65 minutes duration)
- DILR: Data Interpretation and Logical Reasoning (32-34 questions, 60 minutes duration)
- QA: Quantitative Ability (34-40 questions, 70 minutes duration)

Scoring Pattern

The scoring pattern of the CAT exam is based on the number of questions answered correctly and incorrectly. For each correct answer, a candidate is awarded 3 marks. For each incorrect answer, 1 mark is deducted. The total score is then calculated based on the number of correct and incorrect answers. The exact scoring pattern may vary from year to year, and it is essential to check the official website for the most up-to-date information.

Percentile-Based Selection

The CAT exam uses a percentile-based selection process to shortlist candidates for the next round of the admission process. The percentile score is calculated based on the candidate's performance in the exam relative to the performance of other candidates. The top 1% of candidates are awarded a percentile score of 99, and the remaining candidates are awarded a percentile score based on their relative performance. The percentile score is used to shortlist candidates for the next round of the admission process, including group discussions, personal interviews, and written ability tests.

The cut-offs for the CAT exam vary from year to year and from one IIM to another. Generally, the cut-offs are based on the overall percentile score, as well as the sectional percentile scores. Candidates who clear the cut-offs are shortlisted for the next round of the admission process, which may include additional rounds of testing, including group discussions, personal interviews, and written ability tests. The final selection is based on a combination of the candidate's performance in the CAT exam and the additional rounds of testing, as well as their academic background and work experience.